

Faye Travel Insurance

Management Analysis: Customer Experience & Growth Challenges

Team 2

Alexandre Nevells, Joseph Fonseca, Jiaxuan Wu, Zachary Pyskaty, Zeev Tzaban

Background & Secondary Data Research

Company Strategy & Profile

Digital-first: Mobile app + human support (no AI bots)

Growth:

7 → 170+ employees in 4 years

Locations:

Newark, DE (legal) & Richmond, VA (ops)

Competitors:

Allianz Travel, World Nomads

Media Presence:

Forbes, WSJ, USA Today, Time Best Inventions

4.8★ Trustpilot · Time Best Inventions 2025 · Forbes Listed

Industry & Market Data

\$31.25B

Market Value 2025

~\$60B

Projected by 2030

15.4%

CAGR 2025–2030

Key Industry Trends

- Senior citizens are the largest end-user segment
- Demand for digital claims & real-time support
- Competitors (Allianz, World Nomads) launching digital platforms
- Distribution via travel advisor partnerships growing
- Faye: \$100M revenue, OTA partnerships, Ski.com deal

Data Collection Methods & Timeline

Primary Research

- Semi-structured interviews with Ori Ben-Baruch (Senior Agent) & David Abrahams (Manager)
- Focus areas: company structure, operations, workload distribution, growth challenges
- Follow-up discussions to clarify key points
- Compared perspectives across roles to surface common themes

Secondary Research

- Industry reports & market analyses (Grand View Research, AXA Partners)
- Competitor benchmarking: Allianz, World Nomads
- Company materials: mission statements, product positioning
- Reputable business publications: Forbes, WSJ, USA Today, Travel Weekly

Project Timeline

Weeks 1-2
Contact & Planning

Weeks 3-4
Primary Interviews

Weeks 5-6
Secondary Research

Weeks 9-10
Recommendations

Weeks 11-12
Deepen Research

Week 13
Final Submission

Management Issue & Output Problem

Widening gap between rapid growth and the capacity to scale Customer Experience & Business Development simultaneously

Management Perspective

- Travel advisor partnerships are an underdeveloped growth channel
- No large or fully dedicated BD team for consistent outreach
- Missed partnership & sales opportunities across regions/time zones
- Difficulty maintaining service quality at scale

Employee Perspective

- Growing customer request volume creates uneven workloads
- Pressure to respond quickly during high-demand periods
- Hard to maintain empathy standards with heavier case loads
- Outreach to travel advisors treated as 'extra' rather than priority

Emotional Intelligence (EQ)

Definition

Emotional Intelligence (EQ) is the ability to recognize, understand, and manage one's own emotions while simultaneously being aware of, and effectively influencing, the emotions of others.

How EQ Connects to the Output Problem

Key Differentiator:

Faye's human-centered service is powered by empathy, EQ is their core competitive advantage.

Hiring Challenge:

Fast scaling makes it harder to find and train new staff with the right emotional skill set.

Burnout Risk:

Rapid growth → heavy workloads → employees struggle to remain empathetic under pressure.

Trainable Skill:

EQ is not just a personality trait, it can and must be developed, measured, and reinforced.

EQ in Practice: Zappos

Zappos – Customer-Service Specific Empathy

Real-World Example:

A customer called unable to find a wedding shoe. Agent Madison connected personally, her aunt had the same narrow-foot issue. By building a human connection, she identified the core problem and found the right product. This is Zappos' empathy training in action.

Zappos Vision: "Providing the best customer service, customer experience, and company culture."

Relevance to Faye

Faye's human-over-AI philosophy mirrors Zappos' empathy-first culture. Training reps to find personal connection points can sustain Faye's 4.8-star experience even as headcount grows.

EQ in Practice: The Ritz-Carlton

The Ritz-Carlton – Daily "Lineups" for EQ Reinforcement

- Daily 15–20 minute "lineup" meetings across ALL staff — regardless of seniority
- Staff share stories of exceptional service, reinforcing empathy as a cultural norm
- Management encourages front-line workers to put themselves in the customer's shoes
- Exceptional service is recognized and rewarded to reinforce the behavior

Relevance to Faye

Faye should adopt structured daily or weekly check-ins where agents share strong service moments. This institutionalizes empathy, making it a repeatable system rather than an individual trait, and protects service quality at scale.

Motivation in the Workplace

Definition

Motivation is a key driver of organizational performance. Two primary frameworks guide Faye's challenge: Goal-Setting Theory (GST), setting challenging targets to drive performance, and Expectancy Theory (ET), employees' belief that effort leads to valued rewards.

How Motivation Connects to the Output Problem

Expectancy Theory (ET)

Faye employees hold stock options → strong belief that company growth benefits them personally. Ori Ben-Baruch confirmed this as a motivator. ET is healthy at Faye.

Goal-Setting Theory (GST)

Travel advisor outreach lacks a dedicated plan or assigned team. Employees treat it as 'extra time' work. No clear goals = no motivation to prioritize. This is where Faye's motivation gap lies.

Motivation in Practice: Salesforce

Salesforce – Business Development as a Strategic Growth Driver

Prospecting & qualification: BD reps identify potential customers and determine fit before handing to sales.

Relationship-first approach:

BD primes customers so the relationship feels like a friendship before any sale.

Enabling the sales team:

BD work may not appear on paper immediately, but it directly helps sales hit quotas and increases revenue.

Clear internal purpose:

BD reps at Salesforce understand their role in the pipeline, which drives motivation.

Relevance to Faye

A dedicated BD team at Faye would give employees a clear role and purpose in expanding travel advisor partnerships, addressing the GST gap directly.

Motivation in Practice: HubSpot

HubSpot – Outreach Quotas & Progress Monitoring

- BD teams operate under clear outreach quotas: calls, emails, and meetings tracked
- Software monitors goals, which makes progress visible
- Specific targets ensure employees stay motivated with milestones
- Visible progress builds accountability and self-evaluation for employees and management
- This approach is proven to increase motivation and effectiveness

Relevance to Faye

By adopting the quota tracking used by HubSpot, Faye's BD team can directly address the Goal Setting Theory gap, which would provide employees with clarity, and challenge targets that are tied to measurable outreach goals, partnership growth, and driving engagement.

EQ Training for Customer Experience Staff

Core Idea

Faye's competitive advantage is that they prioritize human to human service. However, as volume grows, EQ must be trained and reinforced within the organization. They can't assume that the employees are coming into the position with the necessary EQ. Faye must treat emotional intelligence as a measurable skill that can be developed at every level within the organization.

Structured Workshops

Develop an EQ curriculum covering empathy, active listening, emotional regulation, and de-escalation.

Daily/Weekly Check-Ins

Modeled on Ritz-Carlton's lineup: brief team sessions where staff share strong service stories to normalize empathy.

All-Levels Commitment

Not limited to new hires. EQ training applies to every employee and manager regardless of seniority.

Measurable Standards

Track empathy through customer satisfaction scores, post-interaction surveys, and manager evaluations.

EQ Training – Best Practices & Potential Downsides

Best Practices

- Management must model EQ that is expected of employees
- Employees the behavior of management, not what they are taught in workshops
- Implement empathy into performance reviews
- Use real call/chat examples to make training concrete and relatable
- Start internally before using external trainers to limit expenses
- Recognize and reward employees who exemplify strong EQ publicly

Potential Downsides

- If management does not uphold EQ standards, employee training is useless
- The training costs can be a burden, especially with external providers
- Empathy-focused interactions may slow response times, potentially frustrating impatient customers
- Risk of perceived inauthenticity if training feels scripted or forced

Build a Dedicated Business Development Team

Core Idea

Create a strategic Business Development team focused on identifying new market opportunities, building travel advisor partnerships, and generating leads to increase revenue; converting outreach from an afterthought into a core organizational function.

Dedicated Team Structure

Assign roles specifically for advisor outreach, not added to existing employees' plates.

Clear Outreach Quotas

Measurable goals: calls, emails, meetings per week tracked and reviewed.

Relationship-First Approach

Modeled on Salesforce: BD primes leads so partnerships feel like friendships before formal deals.

Technology-Enabled Tracking

Use CRM tools to monitor pipeline, follow-ups, and close rates across regions and time zones.

BD Team – Best Practices & Potential Downsides

Best Practices

- Hire reps with both product knowledge and strong interpersonal / EQ skills
- Set specific, measurable outreach quotas to maintain accountability and momentum
- Use CRM software to track pipeline visibility and ensure no leads fall through cracks
- Start regionally - prioritize high-density travel advisor markets before expanding globally
- Align BD incentives with revenue outcomes to maintain Expectancy Theory motivation

Potential Downsides

- Hiring reps with poor product knowledge or empathy risks low-quality outreach that could harm the brand
- Costs of salaries, benefits, and tools for a new team may initially exceed revenue generated
- Risk of prioritizing quantity over quality, chasing leads that yield inadequate returns
- Coordination challenges across time zones (US and Israel-based staff)

Communication Strategies & Influencing Tactics

Affiliation – Align with Shared Values

01

- Frame recommendations around Faye's own human-centered mission, not as new ideas, but as extensions of what they already believe
- Reference Zappos and Ritz-Carlton: respected brands Faye already admires, with proven empathy track records
- Leadership is more receptive when recommendations feel like refinements, not risks
- Position EQ training as protecting Faye's core differentiator, not adding bureaucracy

Reasoning – Appeals to Emotion & Outcomes

02

- Don't rely on logic alone, build emotional connection by helping employees see personal benefit
- Emphasize: stronger EQ = more meaningful customer relationships = higher revenue
- Show BD team data: clear goals → accountability → revenue growth (Salesforce & HubSpot evidence)
- Connect stock-option motivation (ET) to how partnership expansion grows company value for everyone